THE GREAT GLUE DISASTER

Original Speculative Comic Script | Ages 5–8 | 3 Pages

Genre: Comedy / Slice of Life **SEL Themes:** Accountability, empathy, honesty, repairing relationships

Format: Panel-by-panel comic script

CHARACTERS

CHARLIE (7) — An enthusiastic inventor with enormous confidence and questionable judgment. His ideas tend to arrive several seconds before his common sense.

ELLA (7) — Charlie's best friend. Clever, adventurous, and perfectly willing to participate in a bad idea—until it becomes a spectacularly bad idea.

MAGGIE (5) — Charlie's younger sister. A proud artist with a vivid imagination and strong opinions about dinosaurs.

PAGE 1 — THE ACCIDENT (3 panels)

PANEL 1 — Wide establishing shot

ART: A cheerful living room with hardwood floors. MAGGIE's handmade clay dinosaur, MR. CHOMP, sits on a low table. Mr. Chomp is gloriously lopsided, with mismatched legs, enormous googly eyes, and a crooked tail. CHARLIE and ELLA are constructing a cardboard rocket nearby.

CHARLIE: Behold! The world's fastest cardboard rocket!

ELLA: It doesn't have wheels.

CHARLIE: That's why it's so fast.

PANEL 2 — Action shot

ART: CHARLIE enthusiastically launches the cardboard rocket across the hardwood floor. It slides straight into the table leg. Mr. Chomp teeters on the edge. CHARLIE and ELLA freeze.

SFX: BONK!

ELLA: Charlie...

CHARLIE: I see it.

PANEL 3 — Large reaction panel

ART: Mr. Chomp hits the floor. His tail breaks off. One leg snaps. His head rolls beneath the couch. His body and remaining legs lie beside the table. CHARLIE stares in horror. ELLA surveys the wreckage.

SFX: KER-CRACK!

CHARLIE: Maggie's dinosaur!

ELLA: Technically, it's three dinosaurs now.

PAGE 2 — THE REPAIRS (5 panels)

PANEL 1 — Medium shot

ART: ELLA retrieves Mr. Chomp's head from beneath the couch. CHARLIE kneels beside the other pieces, holding a large bottle of craft glue. His expression is one of absolute professional confidence.

CHARLIE: Don't panic. I can fix this.

ELLA: That's what you said about the baseball bat.

CHARLIE: It works great!

ELLA: Maybe as a hockey stick.

PANEL 2 — Close-up

ART: CHARLIE squeezes an enormous glob of glue onto Mr. Chomp's broken neck. ELLA holds the head nearby, looking doubtful.

ELLA: Isn't that a lot of glue?

CHARLIE: It's a lot of broken dinosaur.

PANEL 3 — Action panel

ART: CHARLIE presses the head into place. It immediately slips sideways. As he tries to straighten it, his other hand accidentally attaches the tail where the missing leg belongs.

CHARLIE: Hold still!

ELLA: You're talking to the dinosaur.

CHARLIE: He's not listening!

PANEL 4 — Visual comedy panel

ART: The glue bottle lies empty. Mr. Chomp now has a backward-facing head, a tail for a leg, and glue oozing from several joints. CHARLIE tries to lift him from the table. His hand is firmly glued to the dinosaur. The dinosaur is firmly glued to the table. ELLA watches.

CHARLIE: One tiny problem.

ELLA: Which one?

PANEL 5 — Large reveal

ART: CHARLIE has finally freed Mr. Chomp from the table. The dinosaur is crooked, shiny with dried glue, and barely recognizable. CHARLIE's fingers are stuck together. He proudly presents his handiwork.

CHARLIE: Good as new!

ELLA: It's definitely... new.

MAGGIE (OFF-PANEL): CHARLIE? HAVE YOU SEEN MR. CHOMP?

CHARLIE's smile disappears.

PAGE 3 — THE TRUTH (4 panels)

PANEL 1 — Medium shot

ART: MAGGIE enters. CHARLIE quickly hides Mr. Chomp behind his back. ELLA looks between them. MAGGIE notices a broken clay fragment on the floor.

MAGGIE: Where’s Mr. Chomp?

CHARLIE opens his mouth, ready to invent an explanation. He glances at ELLA, then at MAGGIE.

CHARLIE: I broke him.

PANEL 2 — Emotional close-up

ART: CHARLIE brings Mr. Chomp out from behind his back. MAGGIE stares at the damaged creature. Her eyes fill with tears. CHARLIE lowers himself to her eye level.

MAGGIE: But I made him.

CHARLIE: I know. I’m sorry.

CHARLIE: I should’ve told you before I tried to fix him.

PANEL 3 — Quiet beat

ART: MAGGIE holds Mr. Chomp carefully, looking at his crooked head and misplaced tail. CHARLIE and ELLA wait quietly. MAGGIE still looks upset.

MAGGIE: He doesn’t look like Mr. Chomp anymore.

CHARLIE: I know.

A moment passes. MAGGIE tilts the creature sideways and studies it.

PANEL 4 — Large closing panel

ART: MAGGIE suddenly brightens. She holds Mr. Chomp sideways, revealing that his crooked body and misplaced tail make him resemble a strange little dragon.

MAGGIE: Wait! He’s a DRAGON now!

CHARLIE grins with relief. ELLA leans toward him as MAGGIE proudly carries her creation away.

ELLA (WHISPERING): Don’t touch it.

CHARLIE immediately puts both sticky hands behind his back.

CHARLIE: Wasn’t planning to.

END